

Unit 4: Research, understanding and written response

IA2 compulsory unit

Externally assessed

4.1 Unit content

In this unit, students will develop their listening, reading and writing skills in French.

They will develop their ability to listen and respond in French, while learning about the seven general topic areas (GTAs):

- Youth matters
- Lifestyle, health and fitness
- Environment and travel
- Education and employment
- Technology in the French-speaking world
- Society in the French-speaking world
- Ethics in the French-speaking world.

Students will also develop their ability to write in French by studying **one** from a prescribed set of topics, literary texts and films in French:

- Geography topic
- History topic
- Literary texts (literature)
- Films.

The grammar list provided in *Appendix 6* illustrates the level required for this qualification.

What students need to learn

Students will learn to recognise and use the French language in a variety of contexts and in relation to a prescribed range of general topic areas (GTAs). The unit draws upon seven GTAs and a prescribed set of topics, literary texts and films:

General topic areas (GTAs)

Subtopics

1 Youth matters

- Family relationships and friendships
- Peer pressure and role models
- Music and fashion
- Technology and communication

2 Lifestyle, health and fitness

- Food and diet
- Sport and exercise
- Health issues
- Urban and rural life

3 Environment and travel

- Tourism, travel and transport
- Natural disasters and weather
- Climate change and its impact
- Energy, pollution and recycling

4 Education and employment

- Education systems and types of schooling
- Pupil/student life
- Volunteering and internships
- Jobs and unemployment

5 Technology in the French-speaking world

- Scientific advances
- Technological innovations
- Impact on life and environment

6 Society in the French-speaking world

- Migration
- Equality
- Politics
- Customs

General topic areas (GTAs)

Subtopics

7 Ethics in the French-speaking world

- Beliefs
- Law and order
- Moral issues (e.g. euthanasia, adoption, genetic modification)

Set topics, literary texts and films

1 Geography topic

Students would be expected to undertake wide research, become aware of and demonstrate understanding of the following:

- key people, events and issues (e.g. demographic, environmental, economic, social, political) that have impacted or are having an impact on the area in a French-speaking country, region or community
- customs, traditions, beliefs and religions.

The area chosen **must** be in a French-speaking country, region or community.

2 History topic

Students would be expected to undertake wide research, consider and demonstrate understanding of the following:

- a specific period of history of particular relevance to a French-speaking country, key people, events and issues from the above period.

The period of history chosen **must** relate to a French-speaking country, region or community.

3 Literary texts (literature)

- Molière: *Le Bourgeois Gentilhomme*
- Anouilh: *L'Alouette*
- Etcherelli: *Élise ou la vraie vie*
- Guène: *Kiffe kiffe demain*
- Condé: *Le coeur à rire et à pleurer*

4 Films

- Wargnier: *Indochine*
- Falardeau: *Monsieur Lazhar*
- Truffaut: *Jules et Jim*
- Berri: *Jean de Florette and Manon des Sources*
- Malle: *Lacombe Lucien*